

History — Checklist Marking Rubric

Examiner Marking Guidelines & Scoring Rubric — Checklist Edition (atomic, evidence-based criteria for consistent AI/human marking)

TOTAL PAPER MARKS: 40

1. General Principles & Examination Rules

- **Historical Accuracy:** Award marks strictly for historically verified facts, correct chronological contexts, and sound socio-political analysis. Speculative or factually wrong historical claims receive 0 marks for that criterion.
- **Explanation Requirement:** No marks shall be awarded for isolated “point-listing” or standalone bullet points without clear explanation. Each historical point must be developed with cause, context, or effect before its criterion mark is awarded.
- All 2 items are compulsory. Do not award marks for unanswered items.
- Be consistent throughout for all students, strictly applying the same rules throughout. If a particular answer was marked incorrect for one student, mark the same answer incorrect for every other student — never change standard mid-session.
- **Scoring Breakdown:** Full marks on a criterion require a thorough, historically precise, and logically structured explanation. A criterion is awarded 0 if the historical claim is incorrect, the explanation is completely missing, or the content is irrelevant to the criterion.

RACE Competency Integration (apply across every part/task): R – Relevance (directly addresses the prompt, scenario details, and historical concepts); A – Accuracy (correct identification of historical actors, events, trade networks, ethnic movements, legislation, administrative systems); C – Coherence (logical structuring, clear transitions, sound argument development, standard written English); E – Excellence (exceptional depth of historical synthesis, critical evaluation of legacy, meeting all criteria to an exemplary standard). The checklist criteria below already encode Relevance and Accuracy per line; Coherence and Excellence should be treated as a light modifier only within a criterion that is otherwise satisfied (i.e. do not invent extra marks for style beyond the fixed subtotal for each part).

How to use this checklist: each part below is broken into small, independently checkable criteria. Award the stated mark ONLY when the student's answer contains explicit, correct evidence of that specific criterion (a fact, mechanism, named example, or reasoning step). Do not award a criterion for a vague or generic statement that merely gestures at the topic. Partial understanding of a criterion still receives 0 for that criterion — there is no partial credit within a single checklist line; partial credit across a part comes from awarding some lines and not others. Apply every line identically to every student.

Item 1: Pre-Colonial Trade & Heritage Preservation (Total: 20 Marks)

Social Transformation [4 Marks]

Award mark(s) if the answer...	Marks
names a specific pre-colonial trade type or network (e.g. Long-Distance Trade, Regional/Inter-community Trade, Nyamwezi/Akamba/Swahili-Arab trade)	1
explains the emergence of a wealthy merchant class or names a specific merchant leader (e.g. Mirambo of the Nyamwezi, Msiri) who accumulated wealth/power through trade	1
explains resulting social stratification or urbanization (shift from lineage-based governance to stratified society with distinct elites/craftsmen)	1
explains slavery or forced labor arising from trade-fuelled conflict as a social consequence	1
Subtotal	4

Full-Marks Exemplar (model answer — preserved from source rubric)

Pre-colonial trade—specifically local barter networks and Long-Distance Trade involving the Nyamwezi, Akamba, Yao, and Swahili-Arab traders—profoundly restructured East African societies. It facilitated the emergence of centralized kingdoms and powerful merchant leaders (such as Mirambo of the Nyamwezi and Msiri) who accumulated wealth through trade duties and control over commodities like ivory and iron weapons. This wealth transformed social structures from traditional lineage-based governance into stratified societies with distinct merchant elites, specialized craftsmen, and enslaved populations captured during trade-fuelled conflicts.

Zero / Low-Marks Exemplar (incorrect answer — preserved from source rubric)

Pre-colonial trade was when Europeans came to East Africa with trains and built roads. People were trading using dollars and shillings to buy clothes. Culture changed because everyone stopped farming and went to live in big European cities. The trade routes were built by the British government to transport tea and coffee.

Examiner Note: Factually inaccurate. Confuses pre-colonial trade with European colonial transport development and monetary systems. Fails to mention Nyamwezi, Akamba, Swahili routes, or pre-colonial cultural dynamics. Award 0 on every criterion line.

Trade Routes & Networks [4 Marks]

Award mark(s) if the answer...	Marks
names the Central Route with a correct path (e.g. Bagamoyo → Tabora → Ujiji on Lake Tanganyika, extending to Buganda/Busoga)	1
names the Northern Route and its traders (Akamba traders linking Mombasa to the interior around Mount Kenya / Lake Victoria)	1
explains how routes connected interior hinterlands to coastal/market centres	1
explains the growth of specific inland transit towns into urban market centres (e.g. Tabora, Ujiji) enabling regional economic integration	1
Subtotal	4

Full-Marks Exemplar (model answer — preserved from source rubric)

Pre-colonial commerce established distinct inland trade arteries that connected interior communities to coastal ports. The Central Route, pioneered largely by the Nyamwezi, ran from Bagamoyo on the coast through Tabora to Ujiji on Lake Tanganyika and northwards into Buganda and Busoga. The Northern Route, dominated by Akamba traders, linked the Kenyan coast (Mombasa) to the interior around Mount Kenya and Lake Victoria. These routes converted small transit stopovers into vibrant urban market centers (such as Tabora and Ujiji), facilitating movement, geopolitical alliances, and regional economic integration across East Africa.

Zero / Low-Marks Exemplar (incorrect answer — preserved from source rubric)

The trade routes were built by the British government using trains to transport tea and coffee to Europe, and everyone used dollars to pay for tickets.

Examiner Note: Confuses colonial-era rail transport with pre-colonial caravan trade routes; no correct route names, traders, or towns identified. Award 0 on every criterion line.

Cultural Exchange & Impact [4 Marks]

Award mark(s) if the answer...	Marks
explains the spread of Kiswahili as a regional lingua franca through trade contact	1
explains the spread of Islam along trade routes and its effect on religious practice/legal norms	1
gives a specific example of dress/attire change from cultural diffusion (e.g. Kanza, Gomesi)	1
mentions another concrete cultural transfer — architecture, firearms, textiles, or new agricultural crops/dietary habits introduced via trade	1
Subtotal	4

Full-Marks Exemplar (model answer — preserved from source rubric)

Trade acted as the primary vehicle for cultural diffusion in the region. The interaction between inland societies and Swahili-Arab coastal merchants introduced Kiswahili as a regional lingua franca, enabling cross-cultural communication across diverse linguistic groups. Islam spread along trade routes into inland centers, altering traditional religious practices, legal norms, and dress codes (such as the adoption of the Kanza and Gomesi). Furthermore, foreign architectural styles, fire-arms, woven textiles, and new agricultural crops were integrated into local daily life.

Zero / Low-Marks Exemplar (incorrect answer — preserved from source rubric)

Culture changed because everyone stopped farming and went to live in big European cities after trains were built.

Examiner Note: No mention of Kiswahili, Islam, dress, or genuine cultural diffusion mechanisms; confuses pre-colonial trade with colonial urbanisation. Award 0 on every criterion line.

Case for Preservation [4 Marks]

Award mark(s) if the answer...	Marks
gives cultural identity / historical-research value as a reason to preserve the site	1

gives educational value as a distinct reason (future generations, students, researchers)	1
gives sustainable eco-tourism revenue as a reason, contrasted with short-term mall revenue	1
presents the case in a well-reasoned, structured proposal/memorandum form rather than a bare assertion	1
Subtotal	4

Full-Marks Exemplar (model answer — preserved from source rubric)

Rationale for Preserving the Heritage Site (4 Marks):

Preserving the 18th-century settlement site is essential for maintaining Busoga's historical identity and economic potential. Historical Identity and Educational Value: the ruins represent physical evidence of Busoga's pre-colonial economic sophistication, governance, and regional trade connections; destroying them permanently erases local cultural history for future generations. Sustainable Eco-Tourism Revenue: while a shopping mall provides short-term economic returns, a restored heritage site creates a permanent cultural tourism destination — tourists, researchers, and students generate continuous local revenue for hotels, guides, and artisans.

Zero / Low-Marks Exemplar (incorrect answer — preserved from source rubric)

The council must stop the mall because buildings are bad for old places. Elders know everything and youth just want money. We should leave the land alone so spirits can live there, and no one should build anything in the whole town.

Examiner Note: Lacks proposal structure, offers no practical strategy to balance commercial development with preservation, and relies on non-historical/emotional arguments. Award 0 on every criterion line.

Balancing Development & Preservation [4 Marks]

Award mark(s) if the answer...	Marks
proposes adaptive reuse / integrated architecture (heritage ruins incorporated into the commercial design)	1
proposes zoning or a designated municipal heritage protection status for the site	1
names a genuinely practical mechanism (not vague) such as an eco-cultural tourism hub or a heritage park layout	1
clearly demonstrates both commercial growth and heritage preservation being achieved together, not treated as mutually exclusive	1
Subtotal	4

Full-Marks Exemplar (model answer — preserved from source rubric)

Balancing Urban Development with Historical Preservation (4 Marks):

The town council does not need to choose between progress and history; both can co-exist through strategic planning. Adaptive Reuse and Integrated Architecture: the private investor can be required to incorporate the historical ruins into the design of the commercial project — creating a multi-use heritage park and shopping center where retail spaces surround protected archaeological ruins. Zoning and Municipal Heritage Status: the council should declare the 18th-century site a protected municipal heritage zone while directing commercial shopping mall construction to alternative vacant land within the sub-county.

Zero / Low-Marks Exemplar (incorrect answer — preserved from source rubric)

We should leave the land alone so spirits can live there, and no one should build anything in the whole town.

Examiner Note: Offers no practical balancing strategy at all — rejects development outright with a non-historical/emotional argument. Award 0 on every criterion line.

Item 2: Colonial Administrative Policies & Resistance Movements (Total: 20 Marks)

Analysis of Colonial Policies & Resistance [10 Marks]

Award mark(s) if the answer...	Marks
Indirect Rule via sub-chiefs — 1 mark for correctly identifying the policy (e.g. Baganda agents deployed as chiefs in non-centralized regions), 1 further mark for explaining its impact on unity/resentment	2
Arbitrary taxation (hut/poll tax) — 1 mark for correct identification, 1 further mark for explaining the resulting resistance (e.g. Lamogi Rebellion 1911–1912)	2
Forced labor system (Lasanja/Kasanvu) — 1 mark for correct identification, 1 further mark for explaining its disruption of subsistence agriculture / anti-colonial hostility	2
Divide-and-rule tactics — 1 mark for correct identification (e.g. regional role assignment such as North → military, South → civil service), 1 further mark for explaining the effect on national unity/post-independence division	2
Land alienation and enclosure — 1 mark for correct identification (e.g. 1900 Buganda Agreement, Crown/Mailo land), 1 further mark for explaining the resulting agrarian grievances/uprisings	2
Subtotal	10

Full-Marks Exemplar (model answer — preserved from source rubric)

Colonial administrative policies under British rule severely altered local governance, provoked widespread resistance, and undermined long-term national unity in Uganda. Indirect Rule and the Use of Sub-Chiefs: the British extended administrative control by deploying Baganda agents as local chiefs in non-centralized regions like Northern and Eastern Uganda, creating deep-seated sub-regional resentments. Arbitrary Tax Policies: coercive hut and poll taxes forced Africans into the cash economy, triggering armed resistance such as the Lamogi Rebellion (1911–1912). Forced Labor System (Lasanja/Kasanvu): peasants forced into uncompensated labor, disrupting subsistence agriculture and catalysing anti-colonial hostility. Divide-and-Rule Tactics: the colony was structured along ethnic lines (e.g. Northern Ugandans into the military, Southern Ugandans into civil service), preventing a unified national consciousness. Land Alienation and Enclosure: agreements such as the 1900 Buganda Agreement reallocated land as Crown or Mailo land, turning indigenous farmers into tenants and generating lasting agrarian grievances.

Zero / Low-Marks Exemplar (incorrect answer — preserved from source rubric)

Indirect rule made everyone happy because chiefs were local people. Taxes were collected peacefully and used to build free university education for all Ugandans. The Lamogi Rebellion happened because youth had nothing to do in the village. Ugandan unity was strong because the British made everyone speak the same language. Colonial policies had no impact on modern Uganda.

Examiner Note: Contains severe historical inaccuracies (claims Indirect Rule made everyone happy, misinterprets the cause of the Lamogi Rebellion, ignores divide-and-rule dynamics). No marks awarded for unverified or incorrect claims on any criterion line.

Civic Response on Non-Violent Conflict Resolution [10 Marks]

Award mark(s) if the answer...	Marks
Historical cost of violent rebellion — 1 mark for citing a specific historical example (e.g. Lamogi Uprising 1911), 1 further mark for explaining its cost (loss of life, military retaliation, loss of autonomy)	2
Constitutional rights and legal redress — 1 mark for naming a specific mechanism (courts, ombudsman, petition), 1 further mark for contrasting it with the colonial-era lack of such rights	2
Protection of local economic development — 1 mark for identifying that violence destroys infrastructure/investment, 1 further mark for explaining how peaceful negotiation protects livelihoods while still demanding accountability	2
Long-term sustainability through dialogue — 1 mark for naming a specific civic mechanism (town halls, youth delegations, civic advocacy), 1 further mark for linking it to enforceable, lasting policy change	2
Civic mobilization and democratic empowerment — 1 mark for naming non-violent methods (petitions, media campaigns, peaceful assembly), 1 further mark for explaining how they build public/international sympathy versus alienating allies	2
Subtotal	10

Full-Marks Exemplar (model answer — preserved from source rubric)

While your frustration regarding un-consulted taxation and local socio-economic pressure is understandable, turning to violent protests based on historical uprisings like the Lamogi Rebellion misinterprets historical lessons and undermines civic progress. History offers clear lessons on why non-violent, constitutional pathways are more effective. Historical Cost of Violent Rebellions: while rebellions like the Lamogi Uprising (1911) demonstrated courage against colonial oppression, they resulted in massive loss of life, severe military retaliation, and destruction of infrastructure. Constitutional Rights and Legal Redress: modern Uganda operates under a constitutional framework where citizens can challenge unfair laws in courts or petition ombudsmen. Protection of Local Economic Development: violent protests destroy market infrastructure and scare away investment, while peaceful negotiation protects livelihoods. Long-Term Sustainability through Dialogue: lasting peace and policy adjustment are achieved through town halls, youth delegations, and organized civic advocacy. Civic Mobilization and Democratic Empowerment: peaceful petitions, media campaigns, and assemblies build broad public sympathy and international support, while violence alienates elders and potential allies.

Zero / Low-Marks Exemplar (incorrect answer — preserved from source rubric)

Youth should fight the government with weapons because the Lamogi rebellion won all its battles. Non-violence is for weak people who do not care about taxes. Destroying roads and burning markets makes local chiefs listen very fast. History shows that only war changes laws. Youth should refuse to talk to elders because elders work for the colonial government.

Examiner Note: Encourages illegal violence, misrepresents the outcome of the Lamogi Rebellion, provides zero constructive civic mechanisms, and lacks historical accuracy. Award 0 on every criterion line.